

GOVERNMENT & MUNICIPAL BRIEF | MARCH 2026

Trinity Air Link: Fort Worth's eVTOL Gateway

A Public-Private Partnership Proposal for City of Fort Worth Leadership

Prepared for: Fort Worth Mayor, City Council, City Manager, and Economic Development Team. This brief outlines the economic development case, municipal partnership structure, and immediate opportunity created by the federal eIPP program for establishing Fort Worth as the western anchor of Texas's federally sanctioned air taxi network.

\$0

MUNICIPAL INVESTMENT REQUIRED

\$25M+

ANNUAL TAX REVENUE (YR 5)

3,300+

JOBS CREATED

\$500M+

ECONOMIC MULTIPLIER

⚡ **Breaking News — March 9, 2026:** U.S. Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy announced Texas DOT + Archer Aviation as one of 8 national selections for the White House eVTOL Integration Pilot Program (eIPP). Named routes connect **Dallas**, Austin, San Antonio, and Houston. Archer Midnight commercial air taxi operations begin in Texas **this summer**. **Fort Worth is not yet on the route map**. This brief explains why that must change — and how the Trinity Air Link makes it happen.

The Opportunity for Fort Worth

Texas is now one of only eight states in the nation with a federally sanctioned electric air taxi program. The federal government has designated this state — and its partner, Archer Aviation — to prove that commercial air taxi operations can work at scale. Routes are already announced for Dallas, Austin, San Antonio, and Houston.

Fort Worth — Texas's second million-plus city, the fastest-growing city in the DFW corridor, and a municipality with an iconic transportation landmark sitting vacant downtown — has no designated vertiport. The Trinity Air Link corrects that.

1,008,106

FORT WORTH
POPULATION

U.S. Census, July 2024

10th

WORST U.S. COMMUTE

Forbes 2025

174M hrs

DFW DELAY ANNUALLY

+8% year-over-year

\$36.4B

CONGESTION COST BY

2050

Without intervention

What the Link Proposes

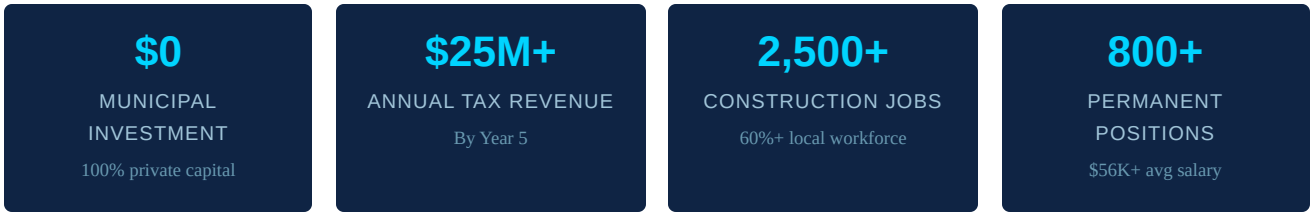
The Trinity Air Link would transform the historic Texas & Pacific Warehouse — vacant since 1998 — into America's first integrated eVTOL and autonomous vehicle transportation hub:

- **Rooftop vertiport:** Multiple simultaneous aircraft landing pads with charging systems and a passenger terminal
- **Ground-level AV terminal:** Level 4 autonomous vehicle fleet for first- and last-mile connectivity across Fort Worth
- **120,000 sq ft Innovation Center:** Floors 2–7 leased to transportation technology companies, research institutions, and startups
- **Public showcase floor:** Community education center, STEM programs, and interactive technology exhibits



The Texas & Pacific Warehouse — 8 stories, 480,000 sq ft, vacant since 1998.

Economic Development Impact



Tax Revenue Breakdown (Year 5)

Source	Annual
Property taxes	\$8–12M
Sales taxes	\$6–10M
Income taxes (payroll)	\$4–6M
Hotel / tourism taxes	\$2–3M
Total Annual Tax Revenue	\$25M+

Comparison: Municipal ROI

Project	Municipal Cost	Annual Benefit
Convention Center	\$540M	Seasonal
Sports Stadium	\$200–500M	Seasonal
Trinity Air Link	\$0	\$25M+ ongoing

The Link delivers the highest municipal ROI of any comparable Fort Worth economic development project — with all financial risk assumed by the private sector.

Broader Economic Multiplier

- ✓ \$500M+ total economic impact over 10 years
 - ✓ 15–25% property value increase in surrounding areas
 - ✓ \$20M+ annual tourism revenue from innovation showcase
 - ✓ 50+ technology companies attracted to Fort Worth
- ✓ \$100M+ in additional technology sector investment
 - ✓ University research partnerships (TCU, UTA, TCC)
 - ✓ National media coverage — CNN, WSJ, Forbes expected
 - ✓ Fort Worth named alongside Dallas as eIPP hub city

Historic Preservation & Community Benefits



T&P Building

The T&P Warehouse — built to serve the railroad era, preserved to serve the next century of mobility.

For Fort Worth Residents

- ✓ 40–60% commute time reduction for TAL users
- ✓ 30% reduction in local traffic emissions
- ✓ T&P Warehouse saved from demolition by neglect
- ✓ 800+ permanent jobs with local hiring priority
- ✓ STEM education programs with FWISD partnership
- ✓ Affordable access commitments for seniors, students, low-income residents

Noise & Safety

Archer's Midnight aircraft operates at **45 dB** — significantly quieter than automobile traffic. eVTOL is 100x quieter than helicopters. Waymo's safety record shows 88% fewer property damage claims and 92% fewer injury claims than human drivers.

Public-Private Partnership Structure

The city's financial risk is zero. 100% of the \$129M capital investment is raised from private sources. The City's role is regulatory facilitation, infrastructure coordination, and community engagement — the same role it plays in any large-scale development.

What the City Provides

- **Regulatory facilitation:** Streamlined permitting and zoning support
- **eIPP endorsement letter:** Letter to TxDOT and U.S. DOT supporting Fort Worth vertiport designation
- **Infrastructure coordination:** Utility connections and traffic management integration
- **Historic preservation:** Collaboration with Landmarks Commission
- **Community engagement:** Joint public education and outreach
- **Economic development:** Tax incentive programs (existing frameworks)

What the City Receives

- **\$25M+ in annual tax revenue** by Year 5
- **3,300+ jobs** created with no municipal capital at risk
- **National recognition** as an eIPP hub city
- **T&P Warehouse resolved** after 27 years of vacancy and code violations
- **Transportation relief** — measurable reduction in Fort Worth's 10th-worst commute
- **Business attraction** — 50+ technology companies and \$100M+ in additional investment

Implementation Timeline

PHASE 1 | 2026

Foundation

City MOU signed · eIPP vertiport designation letter · Permits filed · Historic preservation review · Community engagement begins

PHASE 2 | 2027

Construction

T&P Warehouse rehabilitation · Rooftop vertiport built · AV terminal installed · Innovation center opens (Phase 1 tenants)

PHASE 3 | 2028

Pilot Operations

Air taxi pilot launches · AV fleet deployed · Public showcase opens · 1,000+ pilot participants · STEM programs active

PHASE 4 | 2029+

Full Operations

Full commercial service · 800+ permanent jobs · \$25M+ tax revenue · Fort Worth on national air taxi map

Safety & Regulatory Compliance

Federal Partners

- **FAA:** Early engagement for vertiport certification and airspace integration; eIPP program provides regulatory pathway
- **USDOT:** eIPP program coordination; federal grant applications underway
- **TxDOT:** Emerging Aviation Technology Section (Director Sergio Roman, AAM Lead Emily Lambert) engaged for state-level eIPP coordination

Risk & Insurance

- Aviation liability: \$100M per occurrence
- General liability: \$25M per occurrence
- Property insurance: \$150M replacement cost
- Business interruption: \$25M coverage
- Total annual insurance: \$2–4M

All financial, operational, and insurance obligations are borne by the private sector. The City of Fort Worth assumes no liability.

Partnership Proposal: Immediate Next Steps

Time is a factor. The eIPP window is live. Archer Aviation is standing up Texas operations now, and route decisions are being made this quarter. Fort Worth's window to be named as a designated vertiport city — rather than an afterthought — is measured in weeks, not months.

We Are Requesting Four Specific Actions:

1. **Partnership MOU** — Memorandum of Understanding establishing the City's support role in the Link development
2. **eIPP Endorsement Letter** — Letter from the Mayor's office to TxDOT and U.S. DOT supporting Fort Worth's inclusion in the Texas eIPP network as a designated vertiport location
3. **Expedited Permitting** — Streamlined review for T&P Warehouse stabilization and Phase 1 construction permits
4. **Joint Community Engagement** — Co-hosted public information sessions to build Fort Worth community support for the project



The Trinity Air Link — Fort Worth's answer to the eIPP opportunity.

Schedule a Briefing

We are available immediately for a 20-minute briefing with City leadership, followed by a Q&A session with the project team and financial advisors.

Partnership & Government Relations:

partnerships@trinityairlink.com

Full financial model, technical specifications, and legal partnership framework documents available upon request.